

Phoenix Perry

Reader in Games & Creative Technologies
University of the Arts London — Creative Computing Institute

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01 Research Profile

An interdisciplinary researcher, educator and practitioner working at the intersections of human–computer interaction, creative computing and machine learning for embodied and artistic interaction design.

An artist and activist who uses culture as a medium, Phoenix is Research Lead on the AHRC BRAID UK project *Federated Data Commons for Creative Communities* and a named investigator on funded projects with a combined full economic cost exceeding £850,000. In 2026 they were competitively selected for the AHRC *Doing AI Differently* international research sandpit in Montreal, where they are co-developing *the Anti-Gravity Machine* with a UK–Canada cohort. Their open-source machine-learning tools (InteractML) are used by more than 60,000 developers, and they founded the Code Liberation Foundation, which taught creative computing to 6,000 women between 2013 and 2021. They have authored or co-authored more than 15 peer-reviewed papers and contributed to four books, with new 2026 work at NIME, ACM Creativity & Cognition and CHI PLAY, and completed their PhD at Goldsmiths in 2024. They are a Senior Fellow of the Higher Education Academy.

Research interests — human–computer interaction; games, play and playful interaction; embodied and physical interaction design; interactive and creative machine learning; responsible and generative AI; accessible (“crip”) technology and disability-led design; new interfaces for musical expression; movement and immersive media; and open-source tools that put machine learning in the hands of creative practitioners.

02 Education & Qualifications

PhD, Computing (Computer Science) — Goldsmiths, University of London <i>Thesis: Ctrl Shift — How Crip Alt.Ctrl Designers Change the Game and Reimagine Access.</i>	2024
MSc, Integrated Digital Media — New York University (Tandon / Polytechnic)	2013
BA, English Literature — University of Tennessee	1998
University of Manchester — one year of study in Literature	1996
Senior Fellow, Higher Education Academy (SFHEA)	2023

03 Research Funding & Grants

Named investigator on funded projects with a combined full economic cost exceeding £850,000.

BRAID UK — Federated Data Commons for Creative Communities

Research Lead

AHRC / UKRI, Bridging Responsible AI Divides (BRAID UK) programme · full economic cost £228,153.23.

Responsible AI International Partnership — Bias in AI Music Generation & Analysis

Co-Investigator

Responsible AI UK (RAI UK) International Partnerships, UKRI · full economic cost £122,420 (contribution £97,936.94).

Building a responsible-AI international community to reduce bias in AI music generation and analysis.

4i — Immersive Interaction Design for Indie Developers with Interactive Machine Learning

Co-Investigator

EPSRC · £497,829. PI: Marco Gillies (Goldsmiths); with Rebecca Fiebrink, Bruno Martelli and Ruth Gibson. 2020–2021.

InteractML Unreal Plugin for Interactive Machine Learning

Principal Investigator

Epic MegaGrant (Epic Games) · £21,000. With Rebecca Fiebrink. 2021.

Building Interactive Machine Learning Tools for Game Developers

Principal Investigator

Google · \$20,000 (USD). With Rebecca Fiebrink. 2018–2019.

AHRC “Doing AI Differently” International Sandpit — Montreal, Canada

Selected · 2026

Competitively selected (UK–Canada). Co-developing *the Anti-Gravity Machine* (AHRC × SSHRC) — generative-AI tools that resist dominant cultural attractors and reframe latent space as community-governed collective memory. Full bid submitted.

04 Publications

2026 · NEW

Perry, P. (2026, forthcoming). *Crip Joy and Custom Interfaces: Reclaiming Play Through Open Hardware*. In Proceedings of New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2026).

Perry, P. (2026, forthcoming). *Resident Thrum: Designing for Group Cardiac Synchronization through Multimodal Biofeedback*. In Proceedings of ACM Creativity & Cognition (C&C '26), London, UK.

Perry, P. (2026). *Crippling Play: Co-Designing Custom Game Controllers with Crip and Alt.Ctrl Designers*. ACM CHI PLAY 2026 (under review / in revision; provisional title).

2024 – 2025

Bryan-Kinns, N., Wszeborowska, A., Sutskova, O., Wilson, E., Perry, P., Fiebrink, R., ... Correia, N. N. (2025). *Leveraging small datasets for ethical and responsible AI music making*. In Audio Mostly 2025, University of Coimbra, Portugal.

Bryan-Kinns, N., Sutskova, O., Fiebrink, R., Perry, P., Wilson, E., & Wszeborowska, A. (2025). *Bringing People Into AI*. University of the Arts London. doi:10.58129/9mpb-h282

Bryan-Kinns, N., Fiebrink, R., Perry, P., Wilson, E., & Wszeborowska, A. (2025, Feb 13). *Responsible AI Music Artistic Mini-Projects* [Exhibition]. Rich Mix, London.

Perry, P. (2024). *The Pedagogy of Joy & Engaged Presence*. In Stories of Hope (edited collection of essays, forthcoming).

EARLIER PEER-REVIEWED WORK

- Vigliensoni, G., Perry, P., & Fiebrink, R. (2022). A Small-Data Mindset for Generative AI Creative Work. In *Generative AI and HCI — CHI 2022 Workshop*. New Orleans, USA.
- Perry, P., Fiebrink, R., Grierson, M., Brueggemann, M. J., Doukianou, S., Plummer-Fernandez, M., & Troisi, A. (2022). Art in HCI: A View from the UAL Creative Computing Institute. In *The State of the (CHI)Art — ACM CHI '22 Workshop*. New Orleans, USA.
- Hilton, C., Plant, N., Gonzalez Diaz, C., Perry, P., Gibson, R., Martelli, B., & Gillies, M. (2021). InteractML: Making Machine Learning Accessible for Creative Practitioners Working with Movement Interaction in Immersive Media. In *VRST 2021: ACM Symposium on Virtual Reality Software and Technology*. Osaka, Japan.
- Plant, N., Hilton, C., Gillies, M., Fiebrink, R., Perry, P., Gonzalez Diaz, C., & Zbyszynski, M. (2021). Interactive Machine Learning for Embodied Interaction Design: A tool and methodology. In *TEI '21: Tangible, Embedded, and Embodied Interaction*. ACM. doi:10.1145/3430524.3442703
- Plant, N., Zbyszynski, M., Gonzalez Diaz, C., Hilton, C., Fiebrink, R., Gibson, R., & Martelli, B. (2020). Programming by Moving: Interactive Machine Learning for Embodied Interaction Design. In *NordiCHI '20 Workshop on Programming for Working Bodies*.
- Hilton, C., Gonzalez Diaz, C., Gibson, R., Perry, P., Fiebrink, R., Zbyszynski, M., & Gillies, M. (2020). InteractML: Node-Based Tool to Empower Artists and Dancers using Interactive Machine Learning for Designing Movement Interaction. In *NordiCHI '20 — The UX of Interactive Machine Learning*.
- Plant, N., Gibson, R., Gonzalez Diaz, C., Martelli, B., Zbyszynski, M., Fiebrink, R., & Perry, P. (2020). Movement Interaction Design for Immersive Media Using Interactive Machine Learning. In *7th International Conference on Movement and Computing (MOCO '20)*.
- Gonzalez Diaz, C., Perry, P., & Fiebrink, R. (2019). Interactive Machine Learning for More Expressive Game Interactions. In *IEEE Conference on Games (CoG) 2019*. London, UK.
- Perry, P., & Katan, S. (2016). User-Defined Gestural Interactions Through Multi-Modal Feedback. *BodySense UX Workshop*.
- Schedel, M., & Perry, P. (2013). Devotion Gallery: A Case Study in HCI and Digital Arts Practice. *ACM CHI 2013*.
- Schedel, M., Perry, P., & Fiebrink, R. (2011). Wekinating 000000Swan: Using Machine Learning to Create and Control Complex Artistic Systems. In *NIME* (pp. 453–456).

BOOKS

- Perry, P., & Friedhoff, J. (2015). “Experimental Game Development,” in *OFBook: a community-created open-source book for openFrameworks*.
- Perry, P. (2023). “Generous Art,” in *Processing Foundation 20th Anniversary Community Catalog*. Processing Foundation.
- Levin, G., & Brain, T. (2021). *Code as Creative Medium*. MIT Press. (Contributed interviews.)
- Kean, S., Hall, J. C., Perry, P., & Webb, J. (2011). *Meet the Kinect: An Introduction to Programming Natural User Interfaces*. New York: Apress.

05 Knowledge Exchange & Impact

InteractML — open-source interactive machine learning for Unity & Unreal

2021–2026

— More than 60,000 active users; UAL Knowledge Exchange Staff Award for Innovation of the Year, 2022.

- Funded by Google, Epic Games and EPSRC; commercial work created with Candoco Dance Company, Gibson Martelli, Storyville and Nexus Studios.
- Presented at the Game Developers Conference (GDC), San Francisco and Develop, Brighton; embedded across CCI MSc Creative Computing (Advanced Final Projects, Advanced Computational Environments, Coding 3) and LCC BA Virtual Reality.
- Mentoring of early-career knowledge-exchange and research academics: Clarice Hilton, Carlos Gonzalez-Diaz and Nicola Plant.

Forest Daydream — large-scale interactive installation (Creative Director)

2019–2020

- A week-long 7m × 9m immersive installation funded by the Wellcome Collection (£2,000); shown at the Permission to Play exhibition with roughly 2,000 gallery attendees.

Code Liberation: Create Expressive Videogames — 16-hour MOOC

FutureLearn

- With the Institute of Coding, UAL and Code Liberation; co-created with Charlie Ann Page. Reached roughly 4,000 online learners.

Game Engines Beyond Games — co-curated online symposium

2021

- Presented on the Babycastles Twitch stream; roughly 200 attendees. Also curate and interview for the UAL CCI “Bits and Bytes” YouTube show.

Challenge Lab at Eagle Wharf — Chair of the Steering Group

2022–present

- Criptastic Game Controllers Study (2022), presented on the Indiecade Beyond Screens channel.

06 Industry, Cultural & International Partners

- **Federated Data Commons for Creative Communities (BRAID UK) partners** — Mozilla Data Collective, Creative Commons, the School for Poetic Computation (SFPC) and New York University (co-lead).
- **Anti-Gravity Machine (AHRC × SSHRC) partners** — Factory International, Comfy UI, Brown Arts Initiative and Connected Minds (York University), with Google DeepMind as advisory partner.
- **Funders & industry** — Epic Games, Google, AHRC / UKRI, EPSRC and Responsible AI UK.
- **InteractML adopters & creative collaborators** — Nexus Studios, Candoco Dance Company, Gibson Martelli and Storyville.
- **Sector & accessibility partners** — British Games Institute, National Videogame Museum, Drake Music and the Processing Foundation.
- **Canada** — AHRC × SSHRC *Doing AI Differently* sandpit (Montreal); *Anti-Gravity Machine* UK–Canada consortium (bid submitted), with prospective community partners in Calgary.
- **Responsible AI international** — RAI UK International Partnership building a cross-border responsible-AI community for music generation and analysis.
- **United States & Netherlands** — New York University (ITP, Game Center, Steinhardt, Courant, NYU Poly; Game Innovation Lab; AT&T research collaboration); Utrecht School of the Arts (HKU).
- **Key research collaborators** — Prof. Rebecca Fiebrink and Prof. Nick Bryan-Kinns (UAL CCI); Prof. Marco Gillies (Goldsmiths); Prof. Katherine Isbister; Dr. Margaret Schedel.

07 Academic Employment

University of the Arts London — Creative Computing Institute

Oct 2018–present

Reader, Games and Creative Technologies. Course Leader, MSc Creative Computing (until 2025), and Course Leader, BSc Creative Computing for the CCI's first year (2019). Designed both Creative Computing degrees; lead research and knowledge exchange across games, embodied interaction and creative AI.

Goldsmiths, University of London — Course Leader & Lecturer

2015–2019

Course Leader, MA Independent Games & Playable Experience Design; Lecturer in Physical Computing. Created the Goldsmiths Games Library and a games talk series; taught first-year games programming in Unity; mentored MA theses; redeveloped the physical-computing modules.

UCL, The Bartlett — Teaching Fellow

2017–2018

Technical lead for the Embodied Architecture cluster in Interactive Architecture; supported MA students building embodied VR/MR/AR applications and interactive installations.

Utrecht School of the Arts (HKU) — Senior Lecturer & Core Programming Instructor

2014–2015

Curriculum Committee member for Games & Interaction Design; rewrote the first-year programming curriculum.

New York University — Adjunct Professor

2010–2015

NYU ITP, Game Center, Steinhardt, Courant and NYU Poly. Wrote syllabi across interactive design, Python, embodied play and game development; ran an AT&T research project on reducing texting-related pedestrian deaths and co-authored the white paper; hosted the first Alt.Ctrl Game Jam at the Game Innovation Lab; research member of the Game Innovation Lab and IDM department.

08 Teaching & Academic Leadership

- Helped establish the UAL Creative Computing Institute (CCI) with the founding Dean and Head of Research, shaping its initial research and teaching portfolio.
- Designed the MSc and BSc Creative Computing programmes at UAL CCI, authoring roughly 70% of module specifications and taking both degrees through validation from the ground up with the CCI Dean.
- Created and led the MA in Independent Games & Playable Experience Design at Goldsmiths, including the business case, validation, recruitment and interviewing.
- Unit lead for Critical Studies, Advanced Computational Environments, Physical Computing and Advanced Projects; manage associate lecturers, contracts and the AL budget; mentor MSc students.
- Wrote the module specification for Feminist Computational Practices on the Internet Equalities MA.
- Contribute to student employability through exhibitions of student work, internships and industry-aligned curriculum revision; sit on multiple academic boards.
- Chair, Steering Committee of the UAL Challenge Lab (2022); Co-chair, Disabled Staff Network (2021–2022). Winner, Arts Students' Union "Above and Beyond" Award, 2022.

09 Awards & Honours

- UAL Knowledge Exchange Innovation of the Year, 2022.
- IGF / GDC Award Nomination (Alt.Ctrl category) — Bot Party, 2018.

- Goldsmiths Award for Public Engagement for Early Career Researcher, 2019.
- Women in Games Advocacy Award, 2018.
- Indiecade PlayStation Game Jam Semi-finalist — Crystallon, 2013.
- Maker Faire, two Editor's Choice Awards, Queens, NY, 2011.
- Best of the Bay — “Best Place to Hear the Future,” SF Bay Guardian, 2001.
- Best of the Bay — “Best Pickup Spot for HAL 9000,” SF Weekly, 2002.
- Best Video Artist in San Francisco, FLYER / XLR8R Magazine, 2000.

10 Editorial, Boards & Service

- **Artworks Co-Chair, ACM Creativity & Cognition (C&C '26)** — 2026.
- **ACM Games Editorial Board** (2021–present) — coordinate the Alt Play section; shepherd articles and develop writing talent across industry and academia.
- **Processing Foundation Advisory Board** (2015–present) — mentor staff and advise on inclusive learning materials.
- **British Games Institute (BGI) Advisory Board Trustee** (2018–2025) — advised on inclusion and diversity.
- **TruLuv Advisory Board** (2019–2025) — advisor on qualitative analysis and mentor to the Benefit Director.
- **Peer review & chairing** — reviewer for ACM Games and the International Conference on Movement and Computing (MOCO '18, '19, '20); Conference Chair, Game Engines Beyond Games (2021) and ICMC 2010.

11 Invited Talks & Keynotes

- **Bending the Network: Artists Shaping More Equitable AI Futures** — Future Days, Lisbon, 2024 (Keynote).
- **Technology as Enabler and Extension of the Human Experience** — Science Museum, London, 2024.
- **Sir Run Run Shaw Lecture** — Stony Brook University, USA, 2024.
- **Crippling the Controller** — ACM Games Ethical Games Conference, 2024.
- **Bespoke Games Controllers** — Gotland Games Conference, Sweden, 2022 (Keynote).
- **What do creative coding tool kits of the future look like?** — MIT Future Sketches, 2021 (Keynote / kickoff).
- **Beyond Screens: Alternative Controllers** (with Robin Baumgarten) — Indiecade, 2021 (Keynote).
- **Diversity and Ethics: Critical Perspectives on AI/ML in Musical Interfaces** — NIME, 2020.
- UAL Tech for All Conference (2021); MACHINES+MEDIA, NYC Media Lab (2020); Experimental AI for Games, GDC, San Francisco (2019).
- Open Hardware Summit Keynote, Rome (2014); TEDx Liège (2017); KIKK, Belgium (2018 & 2022); Indiecade Europe, Paris (2019); A MAZE, Berlin (2015); Resonate, Belgrade (2015–2016); Maker Faire UK (2016); Indiecade East, Museum of the Moving Image (2014). Full talk history (pre-2014) available on request.

12 Selected Exhibitions & Creative Work

- **Resident Thrum** — ACM Creativity & Cognition (C&C '26), London (2026).
- **Forest Daydream** — Permission to Play, Wellcome Collection, London (2020).
- **Bot Party** — Now Play This (Somerset House, 2017 & 2019), GDC Alt.Ctrl (San Francisco, 2018), EGX Rezzed (2019), PlayUK / Arcadia (British Council, Skopje, 2018), Apex Art (NYC, 2019), KIKK (2017), We Throw Switches (Edinburgh, 2017), Feral Vector (2018), Clujotronic (Romania, 2018) and Indiecade (LA, 2017).
- **Thrum** — Screenshake, Antwerp (2017); The New Intimacy, Incubate Arcade, Tilburg (2016).
- **Crystallon** — PlayStation Booth, GDC, San Francisco and E3, Los Angeles (2013).
- **Code Liberation at the V&A** — seven-part workshop series and installation, V&A Lates, Parallel Worlds exhibit, London (2016).
- **#000000Swan** — Independent Game Festival (Babycastles), New York (2010); **Nightmare Kitty / Game Over Kinect** — Art & Code 3D, Carnegie Mellon (2011), World Science Fair, NYU Poly (2012).
- Earlier single-channel video and installation work shown internationally (1998–2010), including the Oberhausen Short Film Festival, LACMA, Yerba Buena Center for the Arts and the New York Video Festival. Full exhibition history available on request.

13 Curatorial Positions & Residencies

- Artistic Director / Owner, Devotion Gallery, Brooklyn (2009–2014).
- Art & Music Director, Synth Nightclub & Live Video Project, San Francisco (2000–2002); Co-Curator, Reline DVD series (2001–2004); Artistic Director, Artists' Television Access, San Francisco (1997).
- Harvestworks Industry Fellow (2014) and Artist in Residence (2006).

14 Creative Industries & Founder Roles

- **Code Liberation Foundation** — Founder (2013–2021). Taught creative computing to 6,000 women; designed a 33-hour Introduction to Game Development in C++ at the NYU Game Center.
- **Dozen Eyes Games** — Co-Founder, Creative Director & Developer (2013–2015); work with the US State Department and the New York Historical Society.
- **Do It Kits** — CTO (2016–2018); built interactive electronics learning technology for the UK GCSE curriculum.
- **Devotion Gallery, Brooklyn** — Owner / Artistic Director (2009–2014); featured in The New York Times, Wired, Hyperallergic and Art Forum.
- **FACETS** — Co-Founder (2015–2019), an interdisciplinary un-conference on coding, art and video games.

15 Selected Press

- Creative Lives in Progress — “Make few compromises: Phoenix Perry on pioneering your own path in game design,” 2018.
- Game Developer (Gamasutra) — Alt.Ctrl.GDC Showcase: Bot Party, 2018.

- It's Nice That — International Women's Day feature, 2017.
- Embedded Podcast — "Abuse Electricity," 2017.
- The Drum — Phoenix Perry and Cindy Gallop discuss gaming, 2014.